The Dhāraṇī for Clearing Away the Illness of Indigestion

Toh 1021 · Derge Kangyur

The Dhāraṇī for Clearing Away the Illness of Indigestion is a very brief healing incantation, and its Sanskrit and Tibetan titles are not given in the material available here. After paying homage to the Three Jewels and to the Tathāgata called King of the Radiance of Fire, it presents a short mantra and a simple accompanying rite: one recites the mantra over one's hand and then rubs the belly, which is said to clear away indigestion. It is a practical example of the protective and curative formulas that circulated widely in Buddhist practice, joining devotion to a buddha with a concrete remedy for an everyday ailment. The text is Toh 1021 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the collected dhāraṇīs, the class of short spells and incantations preserved in the canon.

Homage to the Three Jewels.
Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, King of the Radiance of Fire.

tadyathā hure hude huṭagahane svāhā

The rite: after reciting this over one's hand, if one rubs the belly with it, the illness of indigestion will be cleared away.

The Dhāraṇī for Clearing Away the Illness of Indigestion is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The buddha's name, rendered here as "King of the Radiance of Fire," is a translation of the Tibetan. "Bsreg gsol," literally "eater of burnt offerings," is a standard epithet of fire (Skt. hutabhuj or hutāśana). I have not identified a Sanskrit form of the full name with confidence.

The written "lto mnyes nam zhu ba'i" has been read as "lto mnyes na, ma zhu ba'i," that is, "if one rubs the belly, the illness of indigestion." This fits the dhāraṇī's title, which names the illness as "ma zhu ba."

Colophon

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Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.